

# Add indicators

Instance Setup · ~30 min

## BEFORE YOU START

- You've completed **Connect to the platform and Import facility structure**
- Your **FASTR Data Prep Checklist** is open at the *Indicator mapping template* sheet — you'll use column **C — INDICATOR OF INTEREST** (e.g., ANC1, ANC4) and column **G — OFFICIAL INDICATOR NAME IN DHIS2**

## WHY IT MATTERS

Without indicators, FASTR doesn't know what to download from DHIS2 or what to call it in the analysis.

## What you'll do

For each indicator on your list, three moves on one screen:

- 1. Find it** in DHIS2, from inside FASTR
- 2. Name it** — a short ID (e.g., `anc1`) and a readable label (e.g., "ANC 1st visit")
- 3. Save**

All indicators live in **one table**. Each row has a type: **DHIS2 element** (fetched from DHIS2), **Uploaded** (CSV file), **Sum**, or **Calculated** (a formula). Here you create DHIS2 elements.

## 1 Open the indicator list

1. Click **Data** in the top bar, then, in the **HMIS** section, the **Indicators** card.
2. Look at the **default list**. Each row shows the **Indicator ID**, its **label**, its **type**, and the **Defined by** column (the DHIS2 code and its original name). If an indicator on your list is already there, skip it.

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HMIS INDICATORS

Indicator types Special indicators and reserved words

Indicators (26)

Search indicators

Sort Add from DHIS2 Create new

| INDICATOR ID               | LABEL                               | TYPE          | DEFINED BY                     | INCLUDE | STATUS |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------|---------|--------|
| new_fp                     | New family planning acceptors       | Uploaded      |                                | ✓       |        |
| anc1_2                     | Antenatal care 1                    | Calculated    | penta3                         | ✓       |        |
| anc4 <b>Special</b>        | Antenatal care 4                    | DHIS2 element | B19cqs52pelU5<br>B18cqs52pelU5 | ✓       |        |
| del1very <b>Special</b>    | Institutional delivery              | DHIS2 element | mu29mQLjnNw<br>mu29mQLjnNw     | ✓       |        |
| sba <b>Special</b>         | Delivery by skilled birth attendant | Uploaded      |                                | ✓       |        |
| pnc1_newborn               | Postnatal care 1 (newborns)         | DHIS2 element | DM15AJmDN8<br>OMN5AJmDN8       | ✓       |        |
| pnc1_mother <b>Special</b> | Postnatal care 1 (mothers)          | DHIS2 element | DgJergzdefd<br>DgJergzdmfd     | ✓       |        |
| bcg <b>Special</b>         | BCG vaccine                         | DHIS2 element | WMe10f1qeyO<br>WMe10f1qeyO     | ✓       |        |
| zhu92Pwa1FT                |                                     |               |                                |         |        |

**Rows marked "Special"** are read by ID by the analysis modules ( **anc1** , **delivery** , **bcg** ...). Keep those IDs as they are: fill them with the right DHIS2 code rather than creating new ones.

## 2 Search DHIS2

1. Click **Add from DHIS2**, top right of the list. FASTR uses the instance's **stored DHIS2 connection** (the **DHIS2 connection** card on the Data page, the same one as the previous step).
2. In the search field, type a term from column **G — OFFICIAL INDICATOR NAME IN DHIS2** (e.g., `antenatal`) or paste the DHIS2 ID. Click **Search**.
3. In the results, click **Add** next to each element you want. It moves to the **Selected items** column.

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**Add indicators from DHIS2** Next: name indicators (2)

**Search indicators and data elements**

Search by name, code, or ID

Rapid diagnostic test Search Clear

Search completed: 2 results found

|   | Data element                               | Official indicator name in DHIS2 | COCs   |       |
|---|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------|-------|
| > | Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria negative | Qk9nx8171Z                       | 4 COCs | Added |
| > | Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria positive | w2wz28nr9N4                      | 4 COCs | Added |

**Selected items**

2 items selected

|                                            |                     |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria negative | <span>Remove</span> |
| Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria positive | <span>Remove</span> |

4. Search another term if needed; the selection is kept. Then click **Next: name indicators (N)**.

**Tip:** a broad word ( `vaccine` , `delivery` ) brings the whole family at once. Greyed rows saying "Cannot be added" are not monthly counts. **Subgroup** (an age band, a sex)? Unfold the row's **chevron** and add the **COC** line you want, not the main line.

### 3 Name, then save

FASTR proposes an **ID** and a **label** for each element, built from the DHIS2 name. Replace them:

- **Indicator ID** — the technical name. **Lowercase letters, digits and underscores only**, no accents, no spaces (e.g., `mam_new`). For an indicator on the FASTR list, use its standard ID ( `anc1` , `anc4` , `penta1` ...).
- **Label** — the name shown on charts. Accents and spaces are fine; take column **C — INDICATOR OF INTEREST**.

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< Name the new indicators Save

**Data elements**

Each element becomes a new DHIS2 element indicator under the id shown (edit it here; the indicator can be renamed later).

Qk9nnX8171Z Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria negative

Indicator ID: `rdt_malaria_neg` Label: `Malaria RDT negative`

wZwzzRnr9N4 Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria positive

Indicator ID: `rdt_malaria_pos` Label: `Malaria RDT positive`

Click **Save**. Repeat steps 2 and 3 until your whole list is covered.

## Checkpoint

Back on the list, each new indicator shows the **DHIS2 element** badge, its DHIS2 code under **Defined by**, and a tick under **Include**. The **Indicators (N)** counter went up by as many.

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Indicators (28) Search: `rdt` Sort Add from DHIS2 Create new

| INDICATOR ID                                          | LABEL                | TYPE          | DEFINED BY                                             | INCLUDE                             | STATUS                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> <code>rdt_malaria_neg</code> | Malaria RDT negative | DHIS2 element | Qk9nnX8171Z Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria negative | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> <code>rdt_malaria_pos</code> | Malaria RDT positive | DHIS2 element | wZwzzRnr9N4 Rapid diagnostic test for Malaria positive | <input checked="" type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

## What could go wrong

- **"... already exists; choose another id"** — the ID is taken. Open the existing indicator with the pencil and change its DHIS2 code, or pick another ID.
- **"Already added as ..."** — that DHIS2 code is already in FASTR. Nothing to create.
- **The ID is rejected** — an accent, space, comma, bracket, or a reserved word. Lowercase, digits, underscores.
- **DHIS2 search returns nothing** — try another term, or check that the connection's DHIS2 user can read the metadata.
- **"No DHIS2 connection is saved"** — Data page, **DHIS2 connection** card, enter the URL and credentials.
- **Two DHIS2 codes for one indicator** (two age bands to add up) — add both as elements, then **Create new** → type **Sum**.

## What's next

The indicators are defined but **no numbers have been downloaded yet**. Move on to **Import HMIS data**.